

Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujibur Rahman Science and Technology University, Gopalganj

Department of International Relations 2nd Year 1st Semester (BSS Honors)

Course Code: IR206

Course Name: Qualitative Methods in Social Research

Course Teacher: Mahabuba Uddin, Assistant Professor, BSMRSTU

1. Introduction to Social Research –
 - 1.1 Meaning and Significance of research,
 - 1.2 Science and Scientific research,
 - 1.3 features of scientific research,
 - 1.4 Exploratory, Descriptive and Explanatory Research.
2. Theory and Social Research –
 - 2.1 What is theory,
 - 2.2 Deductive and Inductive theorizing, concept, construct, variables,
 - 2.3 Importance of theories in Social research.
 - 2.4 Forms of Explanation: Prediction and explanation, Causal explanation, structural explanation,
 - 2.5 Three major approaches to Social Science: Positive, Interpretive and Critical Approach.
3. Ethics in Social Research
 - 3.1- Why be ethical in social research important?
 - 3.2 Ethics and the scientific community
 - 3.3 Ethical issues involving research participants
 - 3.4 Value free and objective research
4. Literature Review

Where to find literature, How to conduct a systematic literature review, Use of internet for literature review, importance of literature review.
5. Qualitative Sampling - Probability (Haphazard, quota, purposive, snowball, deviant, sequential sampling) and nonprobability samplings (simple random sampling, systematic sampling, cluster sampling)
6. Qualitative Data Collection -Survey Research: what is survey, steps in conducting survey, -Procedures of conducting questionnaire -Types of Survey- Advantages and disadvantages -Process of Interview: Role of an interviewer, face to face interview - Case Research, Focus Group Discussion, Field Survey, Ethnography, Ethnomethodology - Key informant interview, in-depth interview
7. Research process, criteria of good research, common mistakes in research
8. Qualitative Data Analysis - Thematic Analysis , Discourse Analysis, Content Analysis, Phenomenology, Narrative Analysis, Grounded Analysis
9. Research Proposal
10. Referencing: Why it is important, All about APA Referencing Style (7th edition)

Required Readings:

1. Neuman, W. L., (2007). Basics of Social Research: Qualitative and Quantitative Approaches (2nd ed.).

Pearson Education Inc.

2. Lune, H., & Berg, B. L., (2017). Qualitative Research Methods for the Social Sciences (9th ed.). Pearson

Education.

3. King, G., Keohane, O. R., & Verba, S. (1995). Designing Social Inquiry: Scientific Inference in Qualitative

Research'. Princeton University Press.

4. Gerring, J. (2007). Cambridge University Press. 'Case Study Research: principle and Practices'.

Cambridge University Press

5. Miles, M. B., (1994). Qualitative Data Analysis (2nd ed.) Sage Publications.